

Sunday, 19 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Partly cloudy

23° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 13°

GLASGOW

Overcast

23° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Victims of a conman who defrauded 115 elderly people out of millions have spoken out about their ordeal.**
Steven Long stole a staggering £11.5 million, using the money to fund a lavish lifestyle. His victims are now sharing their stories.
CRIME · UK
- A mum was tragically sent a photo of her deceased baby due to horrific mortuary failings at an NHS trust.**
An independent review by Donna Ockenden revealed "recurring examples of failure to protect the dignity of the deceased". It's a truly shocking report.
HEALTH · UK
- The incoming Prime Minister, Andy Burnham, has been criticised by Conservative leader Kemi Badenoch as a 'people pleaser' with 'airy fairy' plans.**
Speaking on Laura Kuenssberg, Ms Badenoch accused Mr Burnham of not understanding the country's priorities. It seems the political sparring is already well underway.
POLITICS · UK
- A fraudster who used £200,000 in Covid loans to invest in stocks has been jailed.**
Rupali Wagh vastly inflated her companies' turnover on her applications for the government loans. Another case of pandemic-era fraud coming to light.
CRIME · UK
- Fire crews are making "really significant" progress tackling a large wildfire in the Cairngorms.**
More than 100 firefighters have been involved in the extensive operation to extinguish the blaze. Let's hope they get it fully under control soon.
ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1

The historic Bayeux Tapestry is in a "wonderful state" after its journey to London, according to the French culture minister.

The 70-metre-long 11th Century embroidery arrived from France last week and is set to go on display at the British Museum. It's a real cultural coup for the UK!

ON AIR – Have you ever seen the Bayeux Tapestry before, or is this a must-see for you?

CULTURE · COMING SOON

2

Original watercolours by ceramicist William Weston Young are expected to fetch up to £25,000 at auction.

A series of these beautiful works are going under the hammer. It's a chance for art collectors to own a piece of history.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of art auctions, or do you prefer to admire art in galleries?

ART · COMING UP

3

Former Love Islander Amber Davies called out an audience member for filming her performance in Legally Blonde.

Amber asked for the theatregoer, who was in the front row, to be removed from the show. It's a reminder of proper theatre etiquette!

ON AIR – What's your take on people filming during live performances? Is it ever acceptable?

THEATRE · NOW

4

British F1 driver Ollie Bearman has been talking about catching up to Kimi Antonelli, and even Harry Kane's F1 potential!

Bearman is making his return to his home Grand Prix this weekend. It's always great to hear about our British talent.

ON AIR – Could you imagine Harry Kane on the F1 track, or should he stick to football?

SPORT · THIS WEEKEND

5

Gracie Abrams' new album is capturing the pain of early adulthood with incisive lyrics, but some critics are left wanting more.

It's the singer's third album, full of witty observations. Always interesting to hear new music from emerging artists.

ON AIR – What's the best new music you've discovered recently?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

On the schedule

1

Great Britain's Josh Kerr has absolutely smashed the men's mile world record in a spectacular performance at the London Diamond League!

Kerr broke the long-standing record, held since 1999, by half a second. What an incredible achievement on home soil!

ON AIR – Have you ever witnessed a world record being broken live? What was it like?

ATHLETICS · UK

2

Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli has taken pole position at the Belgian Grand Prix, leaving team-mate George Russell trailing in fourth.

It's a strong showing for Antonelli in what promises to be an exciting race. All eyes will be on the grid tomorrow.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for the win in Belgium this weekend?

FORMULA 1 · THIS WEEKEND

3

New Zealand's Ryan Fox has equalled The Open record with a stunning eight-under-par 62 on Saturday at Royal Birkdale!

Fox says it will be "cool" to be in the mix on Sunday after this incredible round. He's now joint top of the leaderboard.

ON AIR – What's the most impressive golf shot you've ever seen?

GOLF · UK

4

Keely Hodgkinson has secured her first Diamond League win of the season, beating Femke Broeders-Bol in the women's 800m event.

Another fantastic performance from a British athlete at the London Stadium. She held off strong competition to take the top spot.

ON AIR – Which British athletes are you most excited to watch this summer?

ATHLETICS · UK

5

Northamptonshire Steelbacks have edged a thriller against defending champions Somerset to make the T20 Blast final!

They beat Somerset by 17 runs in a nail-biting encounter. They'll now head to Edgbaston for the final showdown.

ON AIR – Who do you think will take home the T20 Blast trophy this year?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A surprising number of people are finding joy in the simple act of 'cloud watching'.**
It seems gazing up at the sky and identifying shapes in the clouds is becoming a popular way to de-stress. Many report it helps with mindfulness and sparking creativity.
- 2 The trend of 'swapping surplus garden produce' with neighbours is flourishing across communities.**
From courgettes to colossal tomatoes, people are exchanging their homegrown bounty, fostering friendly connections and reducing food waste. It's a lovely way to share the fruits of your labour!
- 3 Experts are noting a rise in the appreciation for 'vintage radio jingles'.**
Listeners are enjoying the nostalgic charm of classic advertising tunes, with many finding them surprisingly catchy and evocative of simpler times. It's a trip down memory lane for the ears!
- 4 More people are embracing the quiet satisfaction of 'ironing pillowcases' to perfection.**
It might sound like a chore, but many are discovering the calming ritual and the luxurious feel of crisp, smooth pillowcases. A small indulgence for a good night's sleep!
- 5 The delightful practice of 'leaving small, hand-painted stones' for others to find is spreading cheer.**
Often featuring uplifting messages or pretty designs, these hidden treasures bring a moment of unexpected joy to those who stumble upon them in parks and along pathways. A lovely little surprise!
- 6 There's a growing interest in 'identifying bird calls' during morning walks.**
Armed with apps or simply their ears, nature enthusiasts are tuning into the dawn chorus, learning to distinguish different species by their unique songs. It adds a whole new dimension to a stroll.
- 7 Many households are rediscovering the cosy tradition of 'reading aloud to each other' in the evenings.**
Whether it's a classic novel or a favourite magazine article, sharing stories together is proving to be a wonderful way to unwind and connect as a family. It's a screen-free delight.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to concentrate, even though it makes us look a bit daft?

ANSWER: PURSING THEIR LIPS AND FURROWING THEIR BROW AS IF SOLVING A GREAT MYSTERY!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to watch their favourite TV show?

ANSWER: ADJUSTING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA TO ACHIEVE PEAK COMFORT!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those 'everyday objects' that have a surprisingly satisfying feel or sound to them?**
Perhaps it's the click of a specific light switch, the smooth texture of a certain mug, or the gentle thud of a well-made door. What are those little things around your home that just feel 'right'?

- **Think about those 'little domestic mysteries' that happen in your home that you can never quite explain.**
Like socks disappearing in the wash, or finding an item in a place you absolutely know you didn't leave it. What are the inexplicable goings-on in your household?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** The London Underground escalators were originally intended to be used with just one hand on the handrail, but early passengers were so nervous they often fell, so staff were employed to reassure them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Big Ben was originally painted entirely green, but the colour was changed to black and gold after a public petition in the 1920s.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The distinctive smell of rain, especially after a dry spell, is called petrichor.
- There are more possible ways to play the first four moves in a game of chess than there are atoms in the universe.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Joseph Nicéphore Niépce, requiring an exposure of several hours.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- The strongest muscle in the human body is the masseter, which is the jaw muscle.

On this day

Day 200 of the year, 165 days left in 2026. Today Palace Day; Christian feast day: Aurea of Córdoba; Christian feast day: Bernold, Bishop of Utrecht; Christian feast day: John Plessington. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Alan Gorrie, Scottish singer-songwriter and musician
- 1989 — James Austin Johnson, American actor and comedian
- 1979 — Luke Young, English footballer
- 1941 — Vikki Carr, American singer and actress
- 1951 — Abel Ferrara, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1992 — Jake Nicholson, English footballer
- 1962 — Anthony Edwards, American actor and director
- 1983 — Helen Skelton, English television host and actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1980 — Opening of the Summer Olympics in Moscow.
- 1997 — The Troubles: The Provisional Irish Republican Army resumes a ceasefire to end their 25-year paramilitary campaign to end British rule in Northern Ireland.
- 1981 — In a private meeting with U.S. President Ronald Reagan, French President François Mitterrand reveals the existence of the Farewell Dossier, a collection of documents showing the Soviet Union had been stealing American technological research and development.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — Tunisia imposes a blockade on the French naval base at Bizerte; the French would capture the entire town four days later.
- 1981 — In a private meeting with U.S. President Ronald Reagan, French President François Mitterrand reveals the existence of the Farewell Dossier, a collection of documents showing the Soviet Union had been stealing American technological research and development.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1947 — Prime Minister of the shadow Burmese government, Bogyoke Aung San and eight others are assassinated.

- 2018 — The Knesset passes the controversial Nationality Bill, which defines the State of Israel as the nation-state of the Jewish people.
- 1969 — Chappaquiddick incident: U.S. Senator Ted Kennedy crashes his car into a tidal pond at Chappaquiddick Island, Massachusetts, killing his passenger Mary Jo Kopechne.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 201 of the year, 164 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Crown Prince Haakon Magnus (Norway); Christian feast day: Ansegisus; Christian feast day: Apollinaris of Ravenna; Christian feast day: Aurelius of Carthage. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Natalie Wood, American actress (died 1981)
- 1973 — Omar Epps, American actor
- 1971 — Sandra Oh, Canadian actress
- 1968 — Kool G Rap, American hip-hop artist
- 1985 — John Francis Daley, American actor and screenwriter
- 1975 — Jason Raize, American singer and actor (died 2004)
- 1943 — Bob McNab, English footballer
- 1944 — T. G. Sheppard, American country music singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Burma's ruling junta puts opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi under house arrest.
- 1969 — A cease fire is announced between Honduras and El Salvador, six days after the beginning of the "Football War".
- 2012 — Syrian civil war: The People's Protection Units (YPG) capture the cities of Amuda and Efrîn without resistance.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1976 — The American Viking 1 lander successfully lands on Mars.
- 1969 — A cease fire is announced between Honduras and El Salvador, six days after the beginning of the "Football War".

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)